

PROCESS — anima.interact

the iterative process record for the ANIMA interactive piece, assembled 19.08.26 for IU000325 (Creative Making: Art & AI). everything referenced here exists in this repository; nothing is reconstructed from memory. exportable as-is to PDF.

what this piece is

the 06.06.26 dream-writing (a 74.5-minute night session, EEG-recorded) materialised as a browser-hosted world typeset entirely in characters: a software renderer with no meshes, no lights, no pixels — the third dimension is an act of typesetting, re-performed every frame. seven canon scenes + four element studies + one data-twin scene, all driven by an environment layer that replays the writing session's own biosignals, honesty-labeled.

the deeper enquiry

the piece did not begin with the build weeks. the night is one manifestation of a longer enquiry — the ANIMA figures, Fate as a recurring character, dreams as a subconscious space, the refusal to force that space into a conscious shape — and the journal noticed all of it before any code existed. rather than paraphrase, the record lets the journal speak: `source/JOURNAL.md` holds the related passages verbatim (censored to only what this work draws on), each linked to where it lives in the piece. the set-aside directions are decisions in this document's timeline, not dead ends: the three.js circuit judged generic (the pivot that found the medium), the form-shop and touchdesigner lanes parked as reference, Eros specified and never trained, character-LLM figures argued as horizon, she_dream excluded, the named EEG channels demoted so the unnamed latent could carry the question.

timeline

- **17.08 — circuit vo.** vite + three.js skeleton of the dream's scenes, prose verbatim (typos preserved as artifacts). walked same day. `shots/v0_*`
- **17.08 — field_01.** the material found: ~28k coloured glyphs, the ambient field made of the writing's own letters, forms condensing out of it. `shots/field01_*`
- **18.08 — form-shop.** blender driven over its MCP socket by the agent; metaball figures → GLB → surface-sampled condensation targets. regenerative scene scripts in `shop/` .
- **18.08 — the verdict.** the polygon walk judged "generic af" — the pipeline worked, the material idea didn't live there. pivot.
- **18.08 — termfield_01.** "forget 3d in the standard context": the page renders the night. heightfield column-march typeset into a character lattice; a z-buffer of characters. `shots/term01_*`

- **18.08 — the style system.** six registers (night · folio · phosphor · rose · page · veil), live-switchable; then tightening, the star catalog + typographic moon, wind, water-text.
- **18.08–19.08 — the split.** engine / env / scenes architecture; six scenes built by six parallel agent instances against a frozen contract (`src/term/scenes/CONTRACT.md`), each verifying itself headless. the EEG pipeline: raw 256Hz → per-second band powers → normalized channels + 1/f slope (`public/eeg/session01.json`).
- **19.08 — divergence.** seven exploration forks (water, sky, ground, beings, concepts, submission, eeg-subconscious) branched and returned: `explorations/*.md` , five walkable studies, and the synthesis in `explorations/CONVERGENCE.md` .
- **19.08 — verdicts + adoption.** four authored verdicts locked (visitation; the mute visitor; both crossings shown; `unshaped` joins canon), then the full adopt wave: speech-as-condensation, whispering moss, wakes, shore gradients, the depletion arc, moon phases, cliff strata.
- **19.08 — the night (v1).** the museum-not-dream verdict answered: a director sequences the writing's order (gate → cloakroom → willow → streetlamp → theatre → boat → the fold), transitions dissolve the world into its own letters, and the margin voice types the writing at the moment each sentence becomes true. full narrated headless playthrough green. frozen as `versions/the-night_v1/` .
- **19.08 — v2, the excavated night.** the author's story-mode note (navigable prose, characters with form/depth/autonomy, illusion of choice / inevitability of encounters, progressive liminality, less abstraction) ran as a structured wave: five parallel fable forks → `explorations/v2/` + `CONVERGENCE_v2.md` ; a cross-model consult (gpt-5.6 over the pi harness, memo pair in `BASAIRA/.pi_tmp/`) whose critique changed the build — *conduct is not intention*, the unwitnessed state; the engine layer (chapter pages, the reading band, the faded hand, chosen→echo, the tempered liminal dial); four opus 5 instances, one per scene-domain, against the frozen contract; then full-night verification (zero errors, honest echo).

method — agents as medium, under authored constraint

the piece was fabricated by claude (fable 5) agent instances — in conversation, in parallel forks, and in exploration fleets — but the authorship structure is a constraint system written and enforced by the author:

- **verbatim prose only.** every displayed line is from the author's own writing, typos preserved. agents never write display prose.
- **likeness drifts; sentiment, archetype, and actions locked** (the author's 18.05.26 rule). figures are presences, never portraits.
- **the honesty taxonomy.** LIVE / RECORDED / MODEL / SIMULATED — every data claim labeled; recorded biosignals presented as state, never content; a detected result never forced to agree with a prior artifact (the two crossings stand in the world, disagreeing).
- **signs type, beings condense.** mechanical speech for notices; condensation for voices — nothing appears from nowhere.
- **the visitor is a guest, and mute.** locked by verdict 19.08.

- **conduct is not intention** (19.08, adopted from the cross-model consult). the night reads position, facing, stillness, timing — but records a verdict only when clearly witnessed; an unmet offer keeps no interpretation and leaves only an '...'. the system refuses to manufacture psychology from telemetry — which is the piece's argument about predictive systems, enforced on itself.
- **verification discipline.** every scene and every change verified headless (console-clean + screenshot review) before it counts as done. the shots in `shots/` are those verifications.
- **provenance discipline.** the author's typed words outrank agent interpretation; decisions are recorded (README settled-ground, CONTRACT non-negotiables) at the moment they land.

parallel agent work was orchestrated as: frozen contract → one file per agent → self-verification → parent integration sweep → authored verdicts → adoption. the fork reports quoted throughout the README are the primary process documents of those phases. from v2 onward the loop also includes a second model family as critic: a design spec is sent to gpt-5.6 ("sol") over the author's pi harness before building, and the adjudicated critique is recorded beside the fork documents (`explorations/v2/CONVERGENCE_v2.md`, `.pi_tmp/ideation-agents/`).

evidence index

- `README.md` — the living log: settled ground, studies, verdicts
- `GUIDE.md` (also `/guide.html`, `export/GUIDE.pdf`) — the walker's guide: how to walk the night + the navigation premises, logic, and reasoning as an eleven-rule constraint record
- `src/term/scenes/CONTRACT.md` — the constitution agents build under
- `explorations/` — seven divergence documents + `CONVERGENCE.md`
- `explorations/v2/` — five v2 fork documents + `CONVERGENCE_v2.md` (with the sol-consult adjudication)
- `source/JOURNAL.md` — the journal where it touches this night: censored verbatim excerpts, each linked to its place in the piece
- `versions/the-night_v1/` — the frozen v1 build + `VERSION.md`
- `BASAIRA/.pi_tmp/ideation-agents/gpt56sol-anima-v2-consult-*` — the cross-model consult, turn and response, verbatim
- `shots/` — ~60 verification and process images, phase-prefixed (`vo_`, `field01_`, `term01_`, `scene_`, `sweep_`, `x_*`)
- `public/eeg/session01.json` + `session01_latent.json` — the processed session (methods in file meta; first 120s trimmed as strap settling; surrogate test: real joint structure 57.4% vs shuffled 18.6%)
- `board.html` — the 98-block reference board (visual language map)
- source headers — every source file carries an ai-use declaration

the AI/ML in this work — approaches used, and refused

for the marker assembling LO2: the piece's AI/ML is deliberate in what it uses and what it declines.

- **agentic LLM fabrication as medium.** the code was written by claude (fable 5) instances — in conversation, parallel forks, and a scene-per-agent build wave (opus 5) — under the authored constraint system above; a second model family (gpt-5.6, "sol") served as design critic, its adjudicated critique recorded. the disclosure granularity is per-file rather than per-section because fabrication was whole-file: the header IS the section comment for everything beneath it.
- **biosignal processing.** the writing session's EEG: per-second Hann-windowed FFT band powers, robust normalisation, a PCA latent (three components, surrogate-tested against shuffled data) — standard signal techniques implemented fresh for this piece, no library code copied; parameters in the data files' meta. the recorded replay drives ambient weather only, honesty-labeled.
- **machine learning refused, kept as limits.** Eros (a QLoRA voice fine-tune) is specified and deliberately untrained; character-LLM figures are argued as horizon, not built. the runtime contains no live inference — a stated position, not an omission.
- **privacy by architecture.** the conduct memory (`dream.chosen` / `echo`) lives in the visitor's own browser localStorage and is never transmitted anywhere; the raw journal and raw EEG stay local — only derived features and cited excerpts ship.

ai-use statement

all code in `src/` and `shop/` was written by claude (fable 5) agent instances working with bilaal aulear, who directed each step, authored the constraint system above, made every design verdict, and verified results in-session. all displayed prose is his writing, verbatim. the critical report accompanying this piece is written by him alone. per-file declarations: see the header of any source file.

current state

the submitted piece is **v2, "the excavated night"** — consolidated deadline morning on the author's word ("as is"). verification at freeze: full-night headless playthrough gate → fold, zero console errors, honest conduct-echo confirmed; twelve scenes sweep clean in lab; production build + smoke green. v1 is preserved whole at `versions/the-night_v1/`. scope frozen: constraint-system artwork now, character-LLM figures argued as horizon in the report. five display lines from journal entries beyond 06.06.26 are in the piece under the corpus-widening law — cited file:line in scene headers, each behind a removable constant (the README carries the register). the critical report is the author's alone. see `explorations/submission.md` for the submission plan this document serves.